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Summarize the 1906 San Francisco Earthquake. What factors shaped the current landscape?

The **1906 San Francisco Earthquake** was one of the most devastating natural disasters in U.S. history. Here's a concise summary:

The Event

- **Date:** April 18, 1906
- **Magnitude:** Estimated 7.9 on the Richter scale
- **Epicenter:** Near the San Andreas Fault, just offshore from San Francisco
- **Impact:** The earthquake caused massive destruction across San Francisco and surrounding areas. Buildings collapsed, water and gas lines ruptured, and fires broke out.

Destruction

- **Deaths:** Estimated 3,000 people
- **Injuries:** Over 10,000
- **Property Damage:** About 80% of San Francisco was destroyed, with more than 28,000 buildings damaged or destroyed.
- **Fires:** The resulting fires lasted for days and caused even more destruction than the shaking itself.

Factors Shaping the Current Landscape

1. **Geology & Fault Lines:**
   The earthquake highlighted the seismic activity along the **San Andreas Fault**, influencing building codes and urban planning in the Bay Area.
2. **Urban Rebuilding & Planning:**
   - Wide adoption of **earthquake-resistant architecture** and stricter construction codes.
   - Modern street layouts and zoning in San Francisco were influenced by reconstruction efforts.
3. **Population & Economic Shifts:**
   Many residents relocated temporarily or permanently, reshaping neighborhoods and population density.
4. **Infrastructure Modernization:**
   Water systems, fire prevention measures, and public utilities were rebuilt to higher safety standards.
5. **Cultural Memory:**
   The disaster ingrained a strong culture of **disaster preparedness** in San Francisco, shaping both emergency policies and public awareness.

In short, the 1906 earthquake not only reshaped the **physical urban landscape** but also influenced the **social, economic, and regulatory framework** that defines modern San Francisco.

If you want, I can also make a **visual map showing before-and-after effects** of the earthquake on the city. It really illustrates the scale of the change.

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